Riley Park

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I am an Assistant Professor in Human-Computer Interaction studying how people think with, argue with, and creatively direct AI systems. My lab builds human-centered interfaces for exploratory data analysis, multimodal prototyping, and collaborative sensemaking, with an emphasis on transparency, controllability, and playful interaction design.

Education

2019–2024 **Ph.D. in Computer Science** New Harbor, USA
- Department of Computer Science, Northlake University
- Advisor: Mira Hollis

  Thesis: *Designing Playful Scaffolds for Human-AI Co-Creation*
  Committee: Mira Hollis, Dana Keene, Elias Romero, Abeni Umahi (Chair)

2017–2019 **M.S. in Information Systems** Mapleton, USA
- Institute for Imaginative Systems, Aurora Metropolitan University
- Advisor: Juno Park

  Thesis: *Ctrl+Alt+Delight: Designing Joyful Debugging Rituals for Collaborative Data Teams*

2013–2017 **B.S. in Computer Science and Design** Nowhere, USA
- School of Engineering and Applied Arts, Mapleton State University
  Undergraduate Honors Committee, Student Representative (2014–2015)

Spring 2018 **Exchange** in Design, Royal Institute of Technology Stockholm, Sweden

Employment

2026–Now **Assistant Professor** Brookhaven, USA
- Department of Computer Science, Brookhaven University
  Direct the Playful Intelligence Lab, mentoring PhD students on AI-supported creativity and explainable interaction.
  Lead cross-disciplinary projects with design, journalism, and public policy partners.
  Serve on the Curriculum Committee and Graduate Admissions Committee.

2024–2025 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow**, Riverton University Riverton, USA
- Advised by Prof. Ada Winters in the Human Lab
  Built interaction techniques for inspecting and steering multimodal assistant behavior in analytical workflows.
  Contributed to the Center Seminar Committee and annual fellowship selection committee.

2022 **Research Scientist Intern**, Civic Interfaces Lab Harbor City, USA
- Designed public-facing visual analytics tools for city climate and mobility planning.
  Co-developed authoring systems for narrative dashboards used by local nonprofits.

2019–2024 **Doctoral Research Assistant**, Northlake University New Harbor, USA
- Advised by Prof. Mira Hollis in the Human-Centered Systems Lab
  Designed and evaluated interaction techniques for collaborative visualization and computational notebooks.
  Contributed to the Graduate Student Advisory Committee and annual fellowship selection committee.

Publication

Journal Articles

2026 J4 **Tea Leaves and Tensor Weights: Ritualized Prompts for Reflective AI Ideation**
Riley Park, Mina Alvarez, Dev Raman
ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction
DOI: 10.00000.000

2025 J3 **Polite Panic Buttons: Designing Graceful Interruptions for Over-Eager Copilots**
Riley Park, Jordan Ng, Samir Patel
IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics
DOI: 10.00000.000

J2 **A Field Guide to Mischievous Dashboards: Debugging Narrative Visualizations in the Wild**
Riley Park, Nora Kim, Asha Menon
Information Visualization
DOI: 10.00000.000

J1 **Keyboard Cat as Co-Author: Improvisational Writing Prompts for Human-AI Reflection**
Riley Park, Tessa Yu, Omar Silva
International Journal of Human-Computer Studies
DOI: 10.00000.000

Conference Proceedings

2026 C9 **Prompt Karaoke: Real-Time Co-Authoring with AI Through Turn-Taking Lyrics**
Riley Park, Imani Brooks, Theo Lin
CHI' 26: *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*
DOI: 10.00000.000

C8 **Nudge, Wink, and Explain: Micro-Interactions for Trustworthy Copilot Suggestions**
Riley Park, Omar Silva, Jia Chen
UIST' 26: *ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology*
DOI: 10.00000.000

2025 C7 **Ctrl+Zebra: Undoing AI Hallucinations in Creative Coding Environments**
Riley Park, Lena Ortiz, Priya Natarajan
DIS' 25: *ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference*
DOI: 10.00000.000
Best Paper Award

2024 C6 **The Surprisingly Serious Button: Playful Affordances for High-Stakes Human-AI Decisions**
Riley Park, Marcus Lee, Faye Donnelly
CSCW' 24: *ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work*
DOI: 10.00000.000

2023 C5 **Chartreuse: Turning Sticky Notes into Living Visual Analytics**
Riley Park, Mina Alvarez, Dev Raman
CHI' 23: *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*
DOI: 10.00000.000
Best Paper Honorable Mention

2022 C4 **Ghost Cursor: Revealing Invisible Collaboration in Shared AI Workspaces**
Riley Park, Samir Patel, Nora Kim
IUI' 22: *ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces*
DOI: 10.00000.000

2021 C3 **Measure the Mischief: Visual Diagnostics for Unruly Recommendation Models**

Riley Park, Jordan Ng, Asha Menon
AVI' 21: *International Conference on Advanced Visual Interfaces*
DOI: 10.00000.000
IEEE Open-Source Badge

2019 C2 **Oops, All Personas: Playful Role-Play Methods for Co-Creating with Language Models**
Riley Park, Amina Farouk, Lena Ortiz
C&C' 19: *ACM Creativity & Cognition Conference*
DOI: 10.00000.000

2016 C1 **Ctrl+Snack: Snackable Notation Designs for Explainable AI Prototyping**
Jingyi Zhou, Marcus Lee, Sandy Fang, **Riley Park**, O'Kelly Beirne, Smitha Sivaramakrishnan
VL/HCC' 16: *IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing*
DOI: 10.00000.000
Test of Time Award

Books and Chapters

2025 B1 **Playful Human-AI Interaction: Methods, Mischief, and Meaning**
Riley Park
MIT Press
DOI: 10.00000.000

Preprints

2025 M1 **Storyboard Signals: Orchestrating Generative Motion Snippets for Expressive Data Narratives**
Riley Park, Amina Farouk, Theo Lin, Xinyi Wang
Under Review
arXiv: 2500.0000

Workshop & Position Papers, Posters & Reports

2025 P4 **From Prompt to Protocol: Positioning Reflective Friction as a Core Design Primitive in Human-AI Systems**
Riley Park, Imani Brooks
CHI 2025 Workshop on Human-AI Co-Creation
DOI: 10.00000.000

2024 P3 **Tiny Rituals, Big Effects: Workshop Paper on Playful Guardrails for Everyday Copilot Use**
Riley Park, Amina Farouk, Theo Lin
UIST 2024 Workshop on Interactive Foundation Models
DOI: 10.00000.000

2024 P2 **Prompt Breadcrumbs: A Poster on Transparent AI-Assisted Writing Traces**
Riley Park, Jonah Singh
ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems Extended Abstracts (Poster)
DOI: 10.00000.000

2023 P1 **Civic Notebook Patterns: Technical Report on Public-Sector Dashboard Workflows**
Riley Park, Nora Kim, Samir Patel
Brookhaven University Technical Report Series
DOI: 10.00000.000

Awards

2026 Early Career Researcher Award, Society for Human-Centered AI
2026 Most Imaginative Study Title Award, International Society for Playful Research Communication
2026 Ten-Year Test of Time Award, VL/HCC [C1]

2025 Best Paper Award, ACM DIS [C3]
2025 Golden Sticky Note for Collaborative Wizardry, Design Futures Assembly
2024 Excellence in Teaching Award, Brookhaven University
2024 Outstanding Mentor in Human-AI Prototyping, Brookhaven Graduate Council
2023 Best Paper Honorable Mention, ACM CHI [C3]
2023 Data Storytelling Spark Prize, Visual Narrative Collective
2022 Open Science Impact Award, Civic Interfaces Consortium
2022 Best Coffee-Fueled Demo Award, Interactive Systems Unconference
2021 Community Builder Ribbon, Human-Centered Computing Network

$ Funding History

- **Playful Interfaces for Explainable Human-AI Collaboration** — National Science Foundation (Program: IIS, Award No. IIS-2641073); PI: Riley Park; Co-PIs: Jordan Hale, Mina Ortiz; Total Funding: $1,245,000; 2026-2029
- **Story-Driven Visual Analytics for Civic Decision Making** — Sloan Research Foundation (Program: Digital Information Technology, Grant No. G-2025-19874); PI: Riley Park; Co-PIs: Elena Ross, Priya Menon; Total Funding: $620,000; 2025-2027
- **Interactive Foundations for Responsible Copilot Design** — Brookhaven University Research Office (Program: Interdisciplinary Seed Grants, Award No. BU-ISG-24-031); PI: Riley Park; Co-PIs: Kaito Nakamura, Sofia Bennett; Total Funding: $185,000; 2024-2026
- **Creative Computing Studios for Human-AI Learning** — Mellon Digital Futures Initiative (Program: Digital Pedagogy, Grant No. MDFI-2024-117); PI: Nora Patel; Co-PIs: Riley Park, Samuel Greene; Total Funding: $310,000; 2024-2025
- **Community Dashboards for Climate and Mobility Planning** — Civic Interfaces Consortium (Program: Public Interest Technology Labs, Award No. CITL-22-044); PI: Ada Winters; Co-PIs: Riley Park, Ian Morales; Total Funding: $540,000; 2022-2024

Professional Service

Program Committee

- ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (2025-26)
- ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (2024-26)
- ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (2023-26)
- ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (2024-26)

Organizing Committee

- Organizing Committee, ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems Workshop on Human-AI Co-Creation (2025-26)
- Organizing Committee, ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology Workshop on Interactive Foundation Models (2024)
- Organizing Committee, IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing Workshop on Creative Coding with AI (2025)

Peer Reviewing 62 full papers 2021 2026

I review for journals and conferences mainly in HCI and visualization, with occasional review work in AI ethics and design research.

Journal

- ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction
- IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics
- International Journal of Human-Computer Studies

Conference

- ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (2022-26)
- ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (2023-26)
- ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (2022-26)
- ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (2021-26)
- ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work (2023-25)
- IEEE Visualization Conference (2023-26)
- ACM Creativity & Cognition Conference (2024-25)

Workshop

- ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems Workshop on Human-AI Co-Creation (2025-26)
- ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology Workshop on Interactive Foundation Models (2024)

Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews:

- ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (2026, ×2)
- ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (2025)
- ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (2025)
- ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (2025)
- ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work (2024)

Community

- Faculty Advisor, HCI Graduate Collective, Brookhaven University, 2024-Present
- Organized mentorship circles, annual demo day, and interdisciplinary design jams

Session Chair

- ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (2025), *Designing with Generative Systems*
- ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (2024), *Creative AI Tools*

Volunteer

- ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (2023)
- IEEE Visualization Conference (2022)
- ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (2021)

Teaching

Spring 2026	Instructor, HCI 640: Human-AI Co-Creation Studio, Brookhaven University
Fall 2025	Instructor, CS 512: Prototyping Intelligent Interfaces, Brookhaven University
Spring 2025	Instructor, CS 301: Introduction to HCI, Brookhaven University
2020-2024	Guest Lecturer, Design Methods for Data-Intensive Systems, Northlake University

Advisee

Ph.D. Students

- **Maya Chen** — Ph.D. in Computer Science, Brookhaven University (Primary Advisor), 2024-Present
- **Rafael Kim** — Ph.D. in Human-Centered Computing, Brookhaven University (Co-Advisor), 2025-Present

Master's Students

- **Elena Park** — M.S. in Computer Science, Brookhaven University, 2024-2026; now Interaction Designer at Atlas AI Studio

- **Jonah Singh** — M.S. in Human-Centered Computing, Brookhaven University, 2025-Present

Undergraduate Researchers

- **Iris Lopez** — B.S. in Computer Science, Brookhaven University, 2025-Present
- **Noah Rivera** — B.S. in Design and Computing, Brookhaven University, 2024-2025; now Product Designer at Northstar Civic Lab

Invited Talks & Demos

Feb. 2026	Keynote, HCI Futures Symposium: *Playful Control: Designing AI Interfaces that Invite Reflection Rather than Obedience*
Nov. 2025	Invited talk, Civic Tech Alliance: *When Dashboards Tell Jokes: Responsible Play in Public Data Tools*
Oct. 2025	Paper presentation for *Ctrl+Zebra*, ACM DIS 2025 (Funchal)
Jun. 2025	Guest lecture, University of Cascadia: *How to Prototype an Argument with an LLM in 30 Minutes*
Apr. 2024	Paper presentation for *The Surprisingly Serious Button*, ACM CSCW 2024 (Virtual)
Sep. 2023	Tutorial, VIS Community Meet-up: *Designing Explainable Interactions for Generative Workflows*
May 2022	Invited seminar, Design + AI Colloquium: *From Prompt to Prototype: Interaction Patterns for Human-AI Ideation*

Media Coverage

Mar. 2026	*The Interface Chronicle*, "This Professor Teaches AI to Explain Itself with Sticky Notes" https://interface-chronicle.example/ai-sticky-notes
Jan. 2026	*Design & Data Magazine*, "Play First, Prompt Second: Riley Park's Lab on Better Human-AI Collaboration" https://design-data.example/play-first-prompt-second
Oct. 2025	*Future of Work Radio*, Interview: "Why Playful Interfaces Make AI Systems Safer" https://futureofworkradio.example/episodes/playful-interfaces-safer-ai
Jul. 2025	*The Civic Technology Review*, "When Dashboards Laugh Back: Public-Sector Lessons from the Playful Intelligence Lab" https://civictechreview.example/dashboards-laugh-back
Apr. 2024	*Computing Today*, "Ctrl+Zebra and the Quest to Undo Hallucinations in Creative Coding" https://computingtoday.example/ctrl-zebra-creative-coding

Skills

Programming	Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, R, SQL, C++
HCI Methods	Mixed-method studies, participatory design, diary studies, think-aloud protocol, thematic analysis
Prototyping	Figma, Framer, React, rapid Wizard-of-Oz setups
AI Tooling	PyTorch, LangChain, vector retrieval pipelines, evaluation harness design
Visualization	Vega-Lite, Plotly, Tableau, D3
Languages	English (native), Korean (professional), Spanish (conversational)

Referees

Dr. Maya Chen
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Carnegie Mellon University, Human-Computer Interaction Institute
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Dr. Daniel Ortiz
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University of Washington, Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science and Engineering
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Dr. Lucas Meyer
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Microsoft Research, Human-Centered AI Group
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Dr. Amina Farouk
Research Scientist
Northeastern University, Khoury College of Computer Sciences
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